dealing with a new government. This is a tactic that China has learned to use with increasing sophistication when dealing with democracies.

At the Russia–India–China Foreign Ministers meeting in China on 27 February 2019, the Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi was at pains to explain that China stood with India on the fight against terrorism and tried to claim credit for the Security Council statement on the Pulwama attack. [9] He proceeded to convey to the Indian External Affairs Minister that the Pakistan government was indicating its willingness to join in a thorough investigation of the facts. China's effort was to try and convince India that this positive affirmation by Pakistan (India had only the word of the Chinese Foreign Minister on this) would lead to an outcome in the 1267 Sanctions Committee; India merely had to be patient.

This tactical argument served the Chinese strategy of delaying any discussion on the listing in the Sanctions Committee on the grounds that India and Pakistan were still talking about the matter. However, India had learned from the earlier Chinese strategy and tactics. The External Affairs Minister Sushma Swaraj made it very clear to her Chinese counterpart that this was not a bilateral issue between India and Pakistan; on the contrary, it was a purely bilateral matter between India and China, since China was the sole member of the Sanctions Committee that was holding up the consensus. The message from India to China was that henceforth there would be no understanding shown of China's position either publicly or privately. India would be prepared to call China out in public.

China expectedly put a 'hold' for the fourth time on 13 March 2019. India expressed disappointment. It began to reach out individually to the members of the 1267 Sanctions Committee to generate pressure on China. Due to India's efforts, both